

The Rich Report

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U.S. ECONOMICS NEWS

- **Treasury Yields:** The 30-year Treasury yield briefly hit 5.18% — its highest since 2007 — before retreating to 4.97% by week-end May 29 as softer PCE data and a tentative US-Iran ceasefire extension eased inflation fears. The 10-year fell from a 16-month high of 4.70% to 4.44%, while markets had been pricing in a rate hike by early next year amid budget deficit concerns and elevated input costs.³
- **Equity Rally:** The S&P 500 closed at an all-time high of 7,580 after nine consecutive weeks of gains — its longest streak since late 2023 — rising nearly 20% from its March lows. Technology led the advance, with Dell surging 30% on AI server demand, quantum computing stocks jumping 44–48% on \$2 billion in anticipated federal grants, and Nvidia reporting record revenue of \$81.6 billion (+85% YoY) alongside \$80 billion in buybacks.³
- **PCE Inflation:** The Fed's preferred inflation gauge, PCE prices, rose 0.4% in April and reached 3.8% year-over-year — the highest reading since early 2023 — while core PCE climbed to 3.3%, a notable acceleration from the 2.6% pace recorded twelve months prior. Spending outpaced flat income growth, pushing the personal savings rate to its lowest level since mid-2022 at 2.6%, a trend analysts view as unsustainable.³
- **Manufacturing Expansion:** The ISM Manufacturing Index rose to 54.0 in May — its highest reading since 2022 and fifth consecutive month of expansion — with new orders climbing to 56.8 and order backlogs growing for a fifth straight month after contracting for over three years. Despite broad improvement across 16 of 18 manufacturing categories, the employment sub-index remained in contraction for a 32nd consecutive month, and the prices paid index stayed elevated at 82.1.³
- **New Home Sales:** New single-family home sales fell 6.2% in April to a 622,000 annual rate — well below the 660,000 consensus — and are down 11.3% year-over-year, pressured by mortgage rates rising roughly 40 basis points since the Iran conflict began. Months' supply rose to 9.4, its highest in recent months, though median prices remain 8% below their October 2022 peak and completed home inventory is at its highest level since 2009.³

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DIGITAL ASSETS NEWS

- **Clarity Act Progress:** House Financial Services Committee Chairman French Hill signaled growing legislative momentum in remarks to CoinDesk, expressing confidence that the Clarity Act will achieve bipartisan support by bridging longstanding Republican-Democrat divides over crypto jurisdiction. Hill identified tokenization — the conversion of real-world assets like equities and real estate onto blockchain rails — as the next critical policy frontier, suggesting Congress is preparing for a broader digital asset regulatory overhaul.⁵
- **Dimon vs. Armstrong — Stablecoin Turf War:** JPMorgan CEO Jamie Dimon openly criticized Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong as tensions escalate over the GENIUS/Clarity Act framework. At issue: whether crypto firms like Coinbase can offer yield-bearing stablecoins — a product banks argue encroaches on deposit-taking territory they're federally regulated to provide. The clash signals that Washington's crypto legislation may fracture along bank-versus-fintech fault lines.⁵
- **Stablecoin Market Cap Hits Historic \$322 Billion:** On May 26, the combined value of all stablecoins surpassed \$322 billion — a new all-time high that eclipses the foreign exchange reserves of 95 sovereign nations, including economic heavyweights like the U.K. and Canada. The milestone underscores stablecoins' growing role as a parallel dollar-denominated financial system operating outside traditional banking infrastructure.⁵

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G E O P O L I T I C S N E W S

- **Canada/Taiwan:** Canadian frigate HMCS Charlottetown conducted a solo transit of the Taiwan Strait on May 22–23, defying earlier Chinese warnings, just days before Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi arrived in Ottawa for the first Chinese FM visit to Canada in a decade.¹
- **Germany:** Germany's €500 billion infrastructure fund is off to a slow start, with only about €11 billion of the €40 billion budgeted for 2026 deployed through April. A similar shortfall occurred in 2025. Authorities say they will seek to accelerate disbursements, but the sluggish pace raises questions about the fund's ability to deliver the economic revival Chancellor Merz promised.¹
- **Iran:** US and Iran struck a preliminary agreement to extend their ceasefire by 60 days and begin nuclear talks, but skirmishing continued. Iran briefly halted diplomatic exchanges in protest of Israel's Lebanon offensive. The deal would reopen the Strait of Hormuz within 30 days of a final agreement and has sent oil prices below \$97 a barrel. Iran also partially restored internet access after a near-total blackout since the February outbreak of war.¹
- **Japan:** Japan spent a record ¥11.7 trillion (~\$73.7 billion) intervening in currency markets between late April and late May to support the yen, its first intervention since 2024. The yen has weakened sharply as Middle East conflict drove dollar demand, raising import costs for food and energy in a country almost entirely dependent on foreign supplies.¹
- **Japan/Russia:** Japan sent senior trade and foreign ministry officials to Moscow to maintain communication channels and protect Japanese corporate assets in Russia, despite ongoing G7 sanctions. Tokyo downplayed the visit's significance, framing it as routine business protection rather than diplomatic engagement.¹
- **South Korea/Samsung:** Samsung avoided a potentially disruptive strike after 74% of union members approved a deal giving each of the company's 78,000 covered workers a bonus of roughly \$370,000, alongside a 6.2% wage increase and a new 10-year semiconductor performance bonus system. The deal came as Samsung's Q1 operating profit surged 750% year-on-year.¹
- **Ukraine/Russia:** Ukraine is deploying AI-assisted kamikaze drones called the Hornet against Russian logistics convoys. Built by US company Perennial Autonomy (founded with Eric Schmidt's backing), the \$6,000 drone has a 100+ km range, is nearly silent, and carries a 4.5 kg payload. Ukraine reportedly quadrupled mid-range strikes between February and April 2026.¹
- **UK:** Prime Minister Starmer faces deepening political trouble as over 1,000 pages of documents were released relating to former US ambassador Peter Mandelson's ties to Jeffrey Epstein and his nine-month tenure before being fired. Combined with dismal poll numbers, the affair is fueling internal challenges to Starmer's leadership.¹

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THE GOOD NEWS

- **Heart Disease Gene Therapy:** A single infusion of an experimental gene-editing treatment reduced LDL ("bad") cholesterol by up to 62% in trial participants, with effects sustained 18 months later. Published in the New England Journal of Medicine, the trial targets a condition killing nearly 800,000 Americans annually — potentially making cardiovascular prevention a one-time treatment rather than a lifetime of medication.²
- **AI Prescription Refills:** Utah's pilot AI prescription-refill program shows strong early results: in cases where the AI recommended renewal, at least one of two reviewing physicians agreed 97% of the time. The system appropriately escalates uncertain cases to human telehealth appointments, offering a promising model for expanding medication access without sacrificing safety oversight.²
- **Broadband Getting Cheaper:** For eleven consecutive years, U.S. residential broadband has delivered faster speeds at lower real prices — a trend that bucks nearly every other category of household spending. USTelecom's 2026 Broadband Pricing Index highlights this as a rare, sustained consumer win driven by infrastructure investment and market competition.²

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DIVIDEND PORTFOLIO NEWS

- **CHD:** Church & Dwight acquired Miss Mouth's, a fast-growing stain remover brand, expanding its consumer products portfolio. The acquisition aligns with CHD's strategy of adding niche, high-growth brands to its household and personal care lineup.⁴
- **GD:** General Dynamics secured a \$106M task order to support the U.S. Air Force's Mobile User Objective System (MUOS), a secure satellite communications network — adding to GD's defense services backlog.⁴
- **LMT:** Lockheed had a busy week — winning contracts worth up to \$380M for FMS support, a \$100.5M F-35 brake heat sink order, and delivering its first ICS-enabled combat system to the U.S. Navy. Analysts flagged rising demand for missile defense, sustainment, and autonomous systems, though a potential SpaceX IPO could pressure legacy defense valuations.⁴
- **NTR:** Nutrien faces an FTC investigation into surging fertilizer prices following farmer complaints — a meaningful regulatory risk. Separately, the company priced a \$1B senior notes offering due 2031 and 2036.⁴
- **QCOM:** Qualcomm faces competitive pressure from Nvidia's push into the PC market with its RTX Spark AI chip, threatening Qualcomm's Snapdragon PC foothold. On the positive side, Qualcomm landed an AI chip deal with ByteDance and CEO Cristiano Amon projected a 40x surge in on-device AI token generation by 2030.⁴

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GROWTH PORTFOLIO NEWS

- **CRDO:** Q4 2026 earnings due after the close Monday with analyst sentiment described as optimistic. Credo completed its acquisition of DustPhotonics, a photonics integration move supporting AI optical networking. Quant snapshot ranked Credo among top-rated names recently.⁴
- **CVX:** Oil slid to a six-week low on U.S.-Iran deal speculation, weighing on Chevron alongside Exxon's seven-session losing streak. Goldman and Citi raised copper price forecasts on supply disruptions. Chevron filed to take a 70% stake in a Greek offshore gas block, CEO warned Venezuela needs better contract terms for investment, and shareholders rejected a proposal for an independent board chair.⁴
- **HOOD:** Robinhood launched Trump Accounts app, agentic trading, and a credit card in rapid succession. The platform was approached by states and public-sector organizations for similar Trump Account versions. Cathie Wood sharply trimmed Robinhood to fund Kratos Defense buys. Robinhood ranked among the week's financial sector gainers.⁴
- **MRVL:** Marvell reported Q1 non-GAAP EPS of \$0.80 (beat by \$0.01) and revenue of \$2.42B (beat by \$10M), up 28% YoY. Q2 guidance topped consensus. Management forecast \$16.5B in fiscal 2028 revenue with \$1B in capacity prepayments and expanded Nvidia partnership. HSBC upgraded on AI networking strength. Marvell also released a 102.4 Tbps switch built for AI infrastructure. Computex featured as a near-term catalyst.⁴
- **NVDA:** Nvidia dominated Computex 2026, highlighting agentic and physical AI, announcing RTX Spark AI superchip for Windows PCs, plans to invest \$150B/year in Taiwan, and a partnership with TSMC on accelerated computing for next-gen fabs. Goldman projects Nvidia and Micron will drive a third of S&P 500 earnings growth in 2026. U.S. tightening AI chip export rules for Chinese firms adds risk. SA analyst upgrade noted earlier in the week.⁴
- **TSM:** TSMC's CEO vowed 30%+ employee incentive hikes as AI profits surge. Reports indicate TSMC will raise 3nm pricing 15% in H2, with potential further hikes in 2027, boosting revenue outlook. Taiwan overtook India as the world's fifth-largest stock market, driven by TSMC's surge. Broadcom partnered with FuriosaAI on a new AI accelerator, with TSM likely the foundry.⁴
- **VST:** Vistra appeared in Ohio news that the state will pause tax incentives for future data centers, a potential headwind for data center-adjacent power demand growth.⁴

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S U M M A R Y

In regard to the United States Economy, markets experienced notable volatility as the 30-year Treasury yield briefly touched its highest level since 2007 before retreating on softer PCE data. Despite those concerns, the S&P 500 closed at an all-time high following nine consecutive weeks of gains, led by a powerful technology rally. PCE inflation accelerated to 3.8% year-over-year, manufacturing expanded to its strongest reading since 2022, and new home sales fell sharply amid rising mortgage rates.

In the world of digital assets, legislative momentum around the Clarity Act is building, with bipartisan support appearing increasingly likely. Tensions are emerging between traditional banks and crypto firms over stablecoin regulation, particularly whether platforms like Coinbase should offer yield-bearing products that banks view as encroaching on their territory. Against this backdrop, the total stablecoin market cap surpassed \$322 billion for the first time, exceeding the foreign reserves of most sovereign nations.

Recently around the globe, Canada signaled independence from Chinese pressure with a solo Taiwan Strait transit. A US-Iran ceasefire extension and preliminary nuclear talks pushed oil below \$97 a barrel. Germany's massive infrastructure fund continues disbursing far below its target pace. Japan intervened in currency markets at a record scale to defend the yen, while Ukraine escalated drone strikes on Russian logistics using AI-assisted autonomous systems costing just \$6,000 each.

For the good news, a single-infusion gene therapy reduced LDL cholesterol by up to 62% in trial participants, with effects holding 18 months later, offering a potential one-time alternative to lifelong cardiovascular medication. Utah's AI prescription-refill pilot earned physician agreement 97% of the time, demonstrating safe automation of routine medical decisions. US residential broadband continued an eleven-year trend of faster speeds at lower real prices, a rare consumer benefit driven by competition and infrastructure investment.

In the news for the dividend portfolio, defense holdings remained active, with Lockheed Martin and General Dynamics each adding contracts across missile systems, satellite communications, and naval platforms. Qualcomm faces growing pressure from Nvidia's PC chip push but secured an AI deal with ByteDance and offered optimistic long-term projections for on-device AI. Nutrien drew regulatory scrutiny as the FTC opened a fertilizer pricing investigation, adding meaningful risk alongside the company's new debt offering.

And, for the growth portfolio, Nvidia dominated Computex with agentic AI announcements and plans to invest \$150 billion annually in Taiwan. Marvell beat estimates and raised guidance, projecting \$16.5 billion in fiscal 2028 revenue backed by expanded AI infrastructure partnerships. TSMC signaled price increases on advanced nodes as AI demand accelerates. Robinhood launched several new products in quick succession, while Credo's upcoming earnings and DustPhotronics acquisition kept attention on optical networking exposure.

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RESOURCES



1. Research accumulated from <https://www.patreon.com/cw/PeterZeihan>, <https://x.com/>, and <https://seekingalpha.com/>
2. <https://newsletter.humanprogress.org/>
3. Research accumulated from <https://www.ftportfolios.com/> and <https://bravosresearch.com/research/>
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